5. On one side is a democratic state, and on the other are authoritarian regimes.

In the past, these differences have had an impact on the role of intelligence in the conflict, they continue to do so today, and it is safe to assume that they will continue to have an influence in the future. The main feature of the role of intelligence in this conflict is its heterogeneity and pluralism.

The Israeli-Arab conflict is a complex and convoluted matrix. The first and most basic variable in this matrix is territory. We customarily refer to the concentric territorial circles of the conflict (one inside the other, with Israel as their common center). In the first, innermost circle, the adversary is the Palestinians. In the second circle are the countries bordering Israel—Lebanon, Syria, Jordan, Saudi Arabia, and Egypt—some of which have official peace treaties with Israel. Others generally maintain hostile policies toward Israel, though there is sometimes a convergence of interests with Israel on a certain level. Even so, all of them have claims against Israel regarding its treatment of the Palestinians, control over the holy places, and more. In the third outer circle are countries that do not border Israel but view themselves as part of the Arab world and are therefore involved on some level in the Israeli-Arab conflict; these include Iraq, the Persian Gulf states, Yemen, Sudan, and North Africa. And in the fourth circle are Iran and Pakistan, Muslim powers that, despite their distance from Israel, show an interest and involvement in the conflict (with Iran's involvement being far greater than Pakistan's).

Military theory asserts that intelligence must be collected on the enemy's capabilities and intentions and that an appropriate response must be prepared based on an assessment of these capabilities and intentions. In applying this principle to the Middle East conflict, we see asymmetry both in the intentions and in the capabilities of the various actors in the Arab coalition against Israel.

The sum of the enemy's capabilities include all elements of the enemy's power (in the case of the Israeli-Arab conflict, the enemy consists of more than twenty countries and a Palestinian entity)—that is, its military, economic, social, diplomatic, internal security, scientific, and technological power and its general national resilience.

The sum of the enemy's intentions refers to the intentions of each of the actors in the coalition against Israel. This is where intelligence encounters a